BRICS members are treated quite well in the AIIB. As Figure 3.7 shows, India, Russia, and Germany hold the second-, third-, and fourth-highest voting shares in the AIIB, with 7.5 percent, 5.9 percent, and 4.2 percent, respectively. Even Brazil, the only founding AIIB member from the Western Hemisphere, holds a 3.0 percent voting share, nearly equivalent to those of France, the United Kingdom, and Indonesia.

For its part, Russia delayed signing on to the AIIB because the Finance Ministry was ready to reject the initiative, given that falling oil prices and sectoral sanctions were forcing painful budget cuts. Word went out that "we have no money to participate in Chinese geopolitical projects," which led the Russian foreign ministry to send a "polite rejection" to China. However, when the issue finally reached the Kremlin, Putin immediately overturned the bureaucratic response and decreed that Russia would indeed join the AIIB.[141]